

RENTAL ASSISTANCE RESOURCES

Prepared for: John Doe

County: Cook, IL

Contact these organizations as soon as possible — funds are limited and programs close when money runs out.

Local Resources — Cook County

Catholic Charities / Faith-Based Emergency Aid

- Cook Catholic Charities / Faith-Based Emergency Aid — (312)655-7700

<https://www.catholiccharitiesusa.org/find-help/>

Community Action / Human Services

- Cook Community Action / Human Services — (312)738-4200

<https://dceo.illinois.gov/communityservices/homeweatherization/communityactionagencies.html>

County Housing Department

- Cook County Housing Department — (312)744-3653

<https://www.illinois.gov/>

Court Self-Help / Tenant Forms

- Cook Court Self-Help / Tenant Forms — (312)793-3250

<https://www.illinoiscourts.gov/self-help/>

Emergency Rental / Housing Assistance

- Cook Emergency Rental / Housing Assistance — (312)744-3653

<https://www.illinois211.org/>

HUD Housing Counseling

- Cook HUD Housing Counseling — 1-800-569-4287

<https://www.hud.gov/counseling>

Legal Aid / Eviction Defense

- Cook Legal Aid / Eviction Defense — (312)341-1070

<https://www.illinoislegalaids.org/legal-information/eviction>

Local Housing Authority

- Cook Local Housing Authority — (312)742-8500

<https://www.hud.gov/states/illinois/renting>

Salvation Army

- Cook Salvation Army — (773)205-3500

<https://centralusa.salvationarmy.org/>

United Way / 211

- Cook United Way / 211 — 2-1-1

<https://www.illinois211.org/>

Key Contacts

- Catholic Charities: (312)655-7700
- Community Action: (312)738-4200
- Emergency Rental: (312)744-3653
- Housing Authority: (312)742-8500
- Housing Department: (312)744-3653
- Human Services: (312)744-5000
- Legal Aid: (312)341-1070
- Salvation Army: (773)205-3500

Statewide & National Resources

- 211: Dial 211 for free local referrals
- Court: (312)793-3250
- HUD: 1-800-569-4287
- United Way: Dial 211 for free local referrals
- HUD Housing Counseling: 1-800-569-4287 or hud.gov/counseling
- Legal Services Corporation: lsc.gov/find-legal-aid

Tips for Applying

- Apply as soon as possible — funds are limited and programs close when money runs out.
- Have these documents ready: lease, eviction notice/court papers, photo ID, proof of income.
- Many programs pay back rent directly to the landlord — ask about this option.
- If you have a pending application, tell the judge at your eviction hearing.
- Some programs require landlord cooperation — contact your landlord early.
- Keep copies of all applications, emails, and reference numbers.

IMPORTANT: This document is provided for informational purposes only. It is not legal advice. If you need legal advice, contact a licensed attorney. You are responsible for your own case and what you say in court.